Problem 4

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Let F_n be the nth term in the Fibonacci sequence, which is defined as follows:

$$F_n = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } n = 1 \\ 1 & \text{if } n = 2 \\ F_{n-1} + F_{n-2} & \text{if } n \geq 3 \end{cases}$$

Then, let $\{O_n\}$ be the sequence of the Fibonacci sequence's *odd*-indexed terms and $\{E_n\}$ be the sequence of its *even*-indexed terms.

Let's observe the sums of these two sequences.

n	O_n	E_n	$\sum O_n$	$\sum E_n$
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				

Proposition 1.

$$\forall m \in \mathbb{N}, \sum_{j=1}^{m} F_{2j-1} = F_{2m}$$

Proof. The proof is by induction on m.

BASE CASE: Consider the case for $m = 1$. Observe,

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{j=1}^{1} F_{2j-1} &= F_{2(1)-1} \\ &= F_{2-1} \\ &= F_1 \\ &= 1\end{aligned}$$

and,

$$F_{2(1)} = F_2 = 1$$

Thus, the result holds for the base case $m = 1$.

INDUCTION: Suppose the result holds for some natural number k. That is,

$$\sum_{j=1}^{k} F_{2j-1} = F_{2k}$$

Now consider the case for $k + 1$. Observe,

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{j=1}^{k+1} F_{2j-1} &= \sum_{j=1}^{k}(F_{2j-1}) + F_{2(k+1)-1} \\ &= F_{2k} + F_{2(k+1)-1} && \text{(by the inductive hypothesis)} \\ &= F_{2k} + F_{2k+1} \\ &= F_{2k+2} && \text{(by the definition of } F_n\text{)} \\ &= F_{2(k+1)}\end{aligned}$$

Notice that the substitution of F_{2k+2} for $F_{2k} + F_{2k+1}$ is valid because the index $2k + 2$ is always greater than 3. So F_{2k+2} sits within the $n \geq 3$ piece of F_n, where $F_n = F_{n-1} + F_{n-2}$.

The result, $F_{2(k+1)}$, has the form F_{2m} for $m = k + 1$. Thus, the result holds in the inductive case. Therefore, by the principle of mathematical induction, the result holds for any natural number m.

□

Proposition 2.

$$\forall m \in \mathbb{N}, \sum_{j=1}^{m} F_{2j} = F_{2m+1} - 1$$

Proof. The proof is by induction on m.

BASE CASE: Consider the case where $m = 1$. Observe,

$$\sum_{j=1}^{1} F_{2j} = F_{2(1)}$$
$$= F_2$$
$$= 1$$

and,

$$F_{2(1)+1} - 1 = F_3 - 1$$
$$= 2 - 1$$
$$= 1$$

Therefore, the result holds for the base case $m = 1$.

INDUCTION: Suppose the result holds for some natural number k. That is,

$$\sum_{2j}^{k} = F_{2k+1} - 1$$

Consider the case for $k + 1$. Observe,

$$\begin{aligned}
\sum_{j=1}^{k+1} F_{2j} &= \sum_{j=1}^{k} (F_{2j}) + F_{2(k+1)} \\
&= (F_{2k+1} - 1) + F_{2(k+1)} && \text{(by the inductive hypothesis)} \\
&= F_{2k+1} + F_{2k+2} - 1 \\
&= F_{2k+3} - 1 && \text{(by the definition of } F_n\text{)} \\
&= F_{2(k+1)+1} - 1
\end{aligned}$$

Once again, the substitution of F_{2k+3} for $F_{2k+1} + F_{2k+2}$ is valid because the index $2k + 3$ is always greater than 3.

The result $F_{2(k+1)+1} - 1$ has the form $F_{2m+1} - 1$ for $m = k + 1$. Thus, the result holds for the inductive case, and by the principle of mathematical induction the result holds for all $m \in \mathbb{N}$.

□